P&C People Skills · Course 1 · Week 4

Warm but Fair

SLO

- 1.6 Respond with empathy while staying objective, separating facts, feelings and assumptions, across journey moments

Models taught

- Empathy vs sympathy (Brené Brown, after Theresa Wiseman): "at least…" is the sympathy tell
- Ladder of Inference (Chris Argyris): What happened → What it means → Conclusion → Action, and how to climb back down
- GROW (Alexander, Fine & Whitmore): Goal, Reality, Options, Way forward

Situations walked through step by step

- "The new hire is always late and doesn't care" → climbing down to the facts (Mondays, a new van route)
- An employee whose parent is in hospital → GROW, without promising what you don't control

20 spoken lines · 260 words · about 1.9 min + Taleemabad intro/outro · LearnFree-style visuals · voice spoken to "you"

#	Spoken line	On screen
01	You can be warm with someone and still be completely fair. read: calmly, with warm conviction	Title card: **Warm but Fair**, *empathy that stays objective*
02	Empathy means understanding their feeling; it does not mean agreeing with their version of events. read: clearly, drawing an important line	Split: **Agree ≠ Understand**
03	Sympathy says "at least"; empathy says "that sounds really heavy". read: gently, contrasting two replies	Split screen: **Sympathy** "At least it's not serious." | **Empathy** "That sounds really heavy." (focus: right)
04	To stay fair, use the Ladder of Inference, from Chris Argyris. read: introducing a useful tool, with curiosity	Ladder: What happened → What it means → Conclusion → Action
05	We climb from what happened, to what it means, to a conclusion, to action, in seconds. read: a little faster, showing how quickly it happens	Ladder: What happened → What it means → Conclusion → Action (climbs up fast)
06	Say a team lead tells you a new hire is always late and does not care. read: setting the scene, matter-of-factly	A person speaks: "The new hire is always late. They just don't care."
07	"Does not care" is the top of the ladder, not the bottom. read: thoughtfully, with a gentle pause	Ladder: What happened → What it means → **Conclusion** → Action · label: "Doesn't care"
08	So you climb down, and ask which days, and what times exactly. read: calmly and curiously	A person speaks: "Which days, and what times exactly?"
09	The facts: late three times in two weeks, all Mondays, about twenty minutes. read: precisely, letting the facts speak	Ladder: **What happened** → What it means → Conclusion → Action · label: 3 times in 2 weeks · all Mondays · ~20 min
10	You ask the new hire openly, and learn their new van route runs late on Mondays. read: warmly, with a small turn of discovery	A person speaks: "My new van route from Rawalpindi runs late on Mondays."
11	Same facts, a very different story, and nobody was judged before being heard. read: with quiet satisfaction	Balance scale: The team lead ⚖ The new hire
12	When someone is struggling, the GROW model helps you support them without rescuing. read: introducing a tool, with care	Model **GROW**: G Goal · R Reality · O Options · W Way forward *(Whitmore, 1992)*

#	Spoken line	On screen
13	Say an employee's parent is in hospital, and their deadlines are slipping. read: softly, with real empathy	A person speaks: "My father is in hospital in Lahore. I keep missing deadlines."

⏸ **CHECKPOINT**: the video pauses here; the LMS asks; the learner must answer to continue. *(Not in the video.)*

Q: An employee whose parent is in hospital asks you to guarantee them two weeks off. What do you say?

A. "Done. I'll make sure you get the two weeks."
B. "Leave isn't my department, you'll need to ask your manager."
C. "Let's look at the options together, and I'll help you ask your manager today." ✓
D. "At least it's only two weeks you need."

If right: Exactly. You stay warm and on their side of the problem, while being honest that the decision sits with their manager. Helping them ask today is support you can actually deliver.

If wrong: The fair and warm answer is to explore the options together and help them ask their manager today. Promising the two weeks feels kind, but leave is the manager's decision, so it is a promise you may not be able to keep, and it is unfair to others who follow the process. Sending them off to their manager is accurate but cold: it leaves them alone at a hard moment. "At least..." is sympathy, not empathy; it shrinks what they are going through.

15	The tempting reply is a promise, but leave is their manager's decision, not yours. read: gently, naming a kind mistake	Split screen: **The promise** "Don't worry, I'll get you two weeks off." | **The support** "That sounds really heavy. Let's work out what would help." (focus: right)
16	Goal: you ask what matters most to them this month. read: warmly and slowly	Model **GROW**: **G Goal** · R Reality · O Options · W Way forward · on screen: "What matters most to you this month?"
17	Reality: what is already in place at work, and what have they tried? read: steadily	Model **GROW**: G Goal · **R Reality** · O Options · W Way forward · on screen: "What's already in place? What have you tried?"
18	Options: compassionate leave, a short spell of working from home, or a moved deadline. read: with gentle encouragement	Options branch out: Compassionate leave · Work from home · Move a deadline (they choose one)
19	Way forward: "Shall we draft the message to your manager together, today?" read: warmly and practically, with lift	Model **GROW**: G Goal · R Reality · O Options · **W Way forward** · on screen: "Shall we draft it together, today?"
20	Warm in your tone, fair in your process: that is the whole balance. read: with calm conviction	Balance scale: Warm in tone ⚖ Fair in process
21	So show empathy, climb down to the facts, and use GROW instead of promises. read: warmly and with energy, a confident close	Recap cards: Empathy, not "at least" · Climb down to the facts · GROW, not promises